

CLASS SIZES

The purpose of this policy is to establish maximum class sizes for general education classes. All class size maximums maintained by Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) must meet or exceed the Standards of Quality established by the Code of Virginia. Targeted average class sizes are lower than the maximum class sizes and established through staffing standards for student-to-teacher ratios, which are adopted annually by the School Board in the yearly operating budget, which can be found on the LCPS website at www.lcps.org/budget.

A. Elementary Schools.

1. Kindergarten. Twenty-five (25) students shall be the maximum class size for kindergarten classrooms; however, all kindergarten classrooms shall have a full-time teacher's aide assigned to the class.

2. Grades 1-3. Thirty (30) students shall be the maximum class size for Grades 1-3; however, if the average daily membership in any Grades 1-3 class exceeds twenty-five (25) students, a full-time teacher's aide shall be assigned to the class. Instructional personnel shall otherwise be assigned in a manner that is in accordance with Virginia law regarding requisite Division-wide ratios.

3. Grades 4-5. Thirty (30) students shall be the maximum class size for Grades 4-5; however, if the average daily membership in any Grades 4-5 class exceeds twenty-nine (29) students, a full-time teacher's aide shall be assigned to the class. Instructional personnel shall otherwise be assigned in a manner that is in accordance with Virginia law regarding requisite Division-wide ratios.

B. Middle Schools. The maximum class size in middle schools shall be thirty (30), with the following exceptions:

1. The maximum class size in middle school physical education and music classes shall be thirty-five (35) in Grade 6.

2. The maximum class size in middle school physical education and music classes shall be forty (40) in Grades 7 and 8.

3. The maximum class size for Career and Technical Education (CTE) courses will comply with specific federal and state requirements, including, but not limited to [8 VAC 20-120-150](#) (Maximum Class Size).

4. Licensed instructional personnel will be assigned in a manner that produces a Division-wide ratio of students in average daily membership to full-time

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equivalent teaching positions not greater than 24:1 in English classes.

C. High Schools. The maximum class size for high schools shall be thirty-two (32), with the following exceptions:

1. The maximum class size in high school physical education and music classes shall be forty (40).
2. The maximum class size for CTE courses will comply with specific federal and state requirements, including, but not limited to [8 VAC 20-120-150](#) (Maximum Class Size).
3. Licensed instructional personnel will be assigned in a manner that produces a Division-wide ratio of students in average daily membership to full-time equivalent teaching positions not greater than 24:1 in English classes.

D. Exceptions. Exceptions exceeding the maximum class size for any school level, but within what is permissible under Virginia law, must be approved by the respective level director and the Chief of Schools and shared with the School Board. To the extent, after September 30 of any school year, the number of students in a class exceeds the class size limit established by Virginia law, LCPS shall notify the parent of each student in such class of such fact, no later than 10 days after the date on which the class exceeded the class size limit permitted by Virginia law. Such notification shall state the reason the class size exceeds the class size limit that is permitted under Virginia law and describe the measures that LCPS will take to reduce the class size to comply with the class size limit established by Virginia law.

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